# Educational Reflection

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Education is regarded as one of the most crucial foundations of the human life, paving way to career success, financial security, self-esteem, and many other factors leading to ultimate success and satisfaction. However, the term “education” is widely misinterpreted, as it is far more complex than memorizing or absorbing pieces of information. Moreover, it is our role as a society to work towards passing knowledge to newer generations by meeting their needs and enhancing their overall learning experience.

Education goes beyond mastering the syllabus or achieving desired grades, it is about building character, thinking critically, and adapting to real world challenges. Murray (2023) mentions that education is the absorption of knowledge, skills, and values, that could be gained through natural life habits, for example through hobbies. Furthermore, according to Naziev (2017), education is what stimulates personal growth and develops abilities. This points out that the perfect education system builds a person with a strong identity and independency rather than purely memorized information.

To ensure effective transfer of knowledge to newer generations, educators need an integrated approach to teaching. Delpit (2012) states that teachers should now target making their classes dynamic through challenging students with deep and interactive work. This will potentially lead to a better connection of students with their teachers, increasing their morale and willingness to learn, which is unlikely in the case of scripted lessons. Moreover, this will equip students with more practical skills, which will give them the sense that they are genuinely learning something new and useful.

There are multiple ways for educators to ensure students' needs are met. According to Cushman (2003), educators can gain knowledge about their students by surveying them, finding out and understanding their students' strengths, weaknesses, and interests. This will give students the sense that their voices are heard, which will cause higher levels of motivation and have significant impact on their overall academic performance. Furthermore, when an educator seems to be interested in each of his students' unique personality or way of learning, this eliminates fear and anxiety early on and ensures that students are relaxed and perform to their full potential.

Empowering students is not just a teaching strategy, it is the factor that transforms classrooms from boring one-way teaching to two-way vibrant conversations that build critical thinking and confidence. Delpit (2012) suggests that when students are challenged as scholars rather than learners, they act like one. This proves the fact that setting the standard high will result in more effort and engagement by students. Furthermore, believing in the capabilities of students will raise confidence and discipline on the long-term and increase chances of success. That sense of empowerment drives students to be creative and analytical, instead of only following their educators' rules blindly.

Ultimately, to reform the education system, abandoning the old-school styles of teaching based on memorization of raw information is required, and instead replacing them with integrated techniques to empower students and allow maximum output. Rather than measuring academic success by test or exam scores, other factors must be put into consideration such as creativity, adaptability, and expression. According to Morris (2025), making learners adopt the mindset of practicing scientists helps them understand topics deeply through experimenting, investigating, asking questions, and building arguments.

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